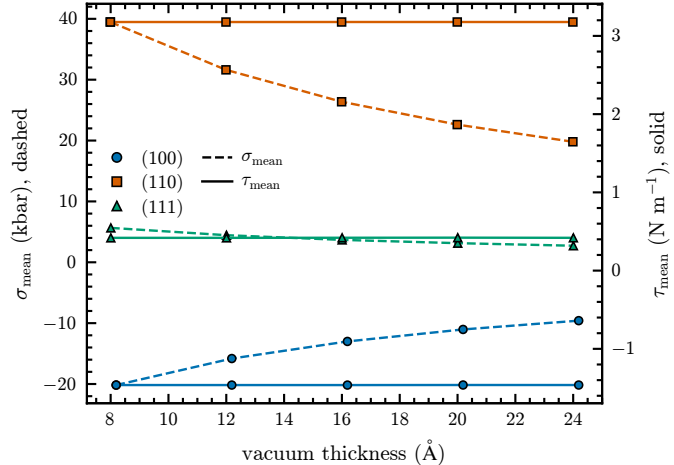




Vacuum convergence of the symmetric H-terminated 6-layer slabs, and the reason surface stress is reported as tau rather than sigma. The raw QE stress (dashed, left axis) is averaged over the whole supercell including the vacuum, so it falls by a factor of 2.1 as the vacuum grows from 8 to 24 Å while nothing physical changes. The vacuum-corrected $\tau = \sigma \cdot L_z / 2$ (solid, right axis) moves by at most 0.0024 N/m across that same range, non-monotonically, which is numerical noise rather than drift. tau is therefore the transferable quantity and 8 Å of vacuum already suffices for it; the apparent sigma convergence problem is an artefact of dividing by an arbitrary cell height, not an unconverged calculation.